

Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata

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Lacoste — Recruitment Team
Paris

Re: Application for ALTERNANCE - Acheteur(se) Merchandising (H/F) (24-month apprenticeship, starting September 2026)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm applying for the ALTERNANCE - Acheteur(se) Merchandising (H/F) apprenticeship at Lacoste in Paris, starting September 2026 for a 24-month contract. I have three years of experience in business development, strategy consulting, and analysis, most recently as a Strategy and Marketing Corporate Consultant Intern at FORVIA, and I'm looking for an apprenticeship in procurement at a company I can stay with long-term.

Lacoste's identity as a globally recognized lifestyle brand built on a genuinely small set of iconic products means its purchasing and commercial functions have an outsized influence on how efficiently the whole group operates behind the scenes. Supporting that kind of group-wide discipline, where the categories are broad but the brand standards are exact, is exactly the work I want to keep building on.

As a Senior Analyst at GEP Worldwide, I worked directly on procurement: my market research on car fleet sourcing delivered a 6% saving for the client, and I regularly drafted and analyzed RFIs, RFQs, and RFPs from the buyer's side. At FORVIA, I now support Purchasing with competitor and market intelligence for their sourcing decisions. My mechanical engineering background means I can read a technical spec and a commercial term sheet equally well, which helps when cost, quality, and delivery all come up in the same negotiation.

I'm currently completing a Master in Management at ESSEC Business School (ranked #10 globally in the Financial Times' 2025 Masters in Management ranking), with coursework in Strategy and Management, Marketing Management, and People and Organizations. Before that, I did a B.Tech in Mechanical Engineering at the National Institute of Technology Calicut (ranked #21 in India, NIRF 2025), with coursework in Operations Research, Project Management, Supply Chain Management, Quality Planning and Analysis, and Production Systems Management. The engineering degree gives me a technical grounding most business-school candidates don't have, and ESSEC has given me the strategy and commercial side.

I'm available to start in September 2026, and I'd welcome the chance to discuss how I could contribute to your team. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata